

LittleReads

Maya and the Brave Little Seed

Nature

Ages 5–7

by LittleReads Editorial Team

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“Yes, please,” he said, “yes in this place, at least, it was not alone, and it was afraid.”

Chapter 1: Underground

Deep underground, the little seed sat in the darkness.

"This is scary," the seed thought. "I cannot see anything. I am all alone."

But the soil was warm and wet, and the seed felt something strange happening inside. A tiny root was pushing down, and a small shoot was reaching up.

"What is happening to me?" the seed wondered.

"You are growing," said a friendly earthworm, wriggling past. "Do not be afraid. Growth happens in the dark, in the quiet, in places no one can see. Trust the process."

The seed was not sure what "trust the process" meant, but it felt the warmth of the soil and decided to try.

Chapter 2: Waiting

Above ground, Maya watered the soil every morning.

"Nothing is happening, Mama," she said on the third day.

"Be patient," her mother said. "Seeds take time. The roots are growing deep underground. When they are strong enough, the plant will appear."

Maya waited. She watered. She waited some more.

Day five. Nothing.

Day seven. Nothing.

Day ten. Nothing.

Maya was about to give up when she noticed something. A tiny green shoot, barely bigger than a thread, was poking through the soil.

"MAMA! It is growing! It is growing!"

Chapter 3: Reaching for the Sun

Now that the little plant had broken through the soil, everything happened faster.

The shoot stretched toward the sun, growing taller every day. Two small leaves opened on either side like little hands waving hello.

Maya named the plant Little Green.

"You are so brave, Little Green. You grew all the way up from the dark."

But growing was not easy. One day, a strong wind bent Little Green almost to the ground.

Maya rushed outside. "Are you okay?"

The next morning, Little Green was standing up straight again. The wind had made its stem stronger.

"Wow," said Maya. "The hard things made you stronger."

Chapter 4: Blooming

Weeks passed. Little Green grew taller and wider. More leaves appeared. And then, one bright morning, a bud appeared at the top.

Maya could hardly breathe. "Is that a flower?"

She watched it every day. The bud grew bigger and bigger, swelling with colour inside.

Then one afternoon, the bud opened.

It was a beautiful flower — bright yellow petals with a soft, sweet scent. Maya had never seen anything so wonderful.

"You did it, Little Green! You grew from a tiny seed into the most beautiful flower in the garden!"

Chapter 5: Seeds for Tomorrow

As the weeks went on, more flowers bloomed. Bees came to visit. Butterflies danced around the petals.

Maya sat in the garden and thought about the journey from seed to flower.

It had taken patience. It had taken care. It had taken time.

"Mama," she said. "I learned something important."

"What is that, my love?"

"Beautiful things do not happen overnight. You have to wait, and care, and believe that something wonderful is growing, even when you cannot see it yet."

Her mother smiled. "That is one of the wisest things anyone has ever said."

That autumn, Maya collected seeds from Little Green's flowers. She gave them to her friends at school.

"Plant these," she said. "Water them. Be patient. And watch something beautiful grow."

What We Learned

- Growth happens gradually, and patience is essential.
- Hard experiences can make us stronger.
- Caring for living things teaches us responsibility.
- Beautiful things take time to develop.

Discussion Questions

1. Why was the seed scared underground?
2. What made the plant stronger after the storm?
3. Is there something in your life that is growing slowly? How can you be patient?

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Thank you for reading!

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